

AI Coding Agents

A Practical Map of the Four Workflow Types



	TYPE 1 IDE Agents	TYPE 2 Terminal Agents	TYPE 3 PR Agents	TYPE 4 Cloud Agents
Where It Runs	Editor	Terminal	Version control platform	Remote or managed environments
Interaction Style	Interactive	Conversational	Async	Fire-and-forget
Autonomy Level	Supervised	Supervised	Semi-autonomous	Highly autonomous
Best For	Quick edits, refactoring, & iteration	Complex multi-file changes	Code review & quality gates	Long-running tasks & prototyping
EXAMPLE TOOLS	AI-native IDEs and integrations that suggest edits inline with visual diffs. ▶ Cursor ▶ Windsurf ▶ Kiro ▶ GitHub Copilot ▶ Continue (local)	Shell agents that read files, propose edits, and run commands with your approval. ▶ Claude Code ▶ Aider ▶ Gemini CLI ▶ OpenCode ▶ Codex CLI	Async reviewers that flag bugs, style issues, and logic gaps on pull requests. ▶ CodeRabbit ▶ Copilot code review ▶ Claude Code Review ▶ Cursor Bugbot	Remote agents that handle scoped tasks and report back with a PR or prototype. ▶ Devin ▶ Claude Code (web) ▶ Codex web ▶ Cursor Cloud Agents

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1

Match the workflow to the task.

Categories describe interaction modes, not products. One tool (e.g., Claude Code) often spans multiple workflows.
- 2

Check your privacy constraints.

Cloud-backed agents send code to external servers. Use local models (Ollama, Continue) when policy requires it.
- 3

Human review stays non-negotiable.

The more autonomous the agent, the more critical the review step. Never ship code you haven't read.